Answer key

SAT Practice Test 2, Reading and Writing

Module 1

NO.	ANSWER	SKILL
1	C	Words in context
2	A	Words in context
3	D	Words in context
4	B	Words in context
5	A	Words in context
6	B	Words in context
7	C	Text structure and purpose
8	D	Text structure and purpose
9	B	Text structure and purpose
10	C	Central ideas and details
11	D	Central ideas and details
12	A	Command of evidence: quantitative
13	A	Command of evidence: quantitative
14	D	Command of evidence: textual
15	C	Command of evidence: textual
16	B	Command of evidence: textual
17	A	Inferences
18	B	Inferences
19	D	Inferences
20	C	Form, structure, and sense
21	C	Boundaries
22	A	Form, structure, and sense
23	B	Boundaries
24	D	Form, structure, and sense
25	D	Boundaries
26	B	Form, structure, and sense
27	C	Boundaries
28	A	Transitions
29	A	Transitions
30	B	Transitions
31	D	Rhetorical synthesis
32	C	Rhetorical synthesis
33	A	Rhetorical synthesis

Module 2

NO.	ANSWER	SKILL
1	A	Words in context
2	D	Words in context
3	B	Words in context
4	C	Words in context
5	B	Words in context
6	A	Words in context
7	C	Text structure and purpose
8	D	Text structure and purpose
9	C	Text structure and purpose
10	D	Cross-text connections
11	B	Central ideas and details
12	A	Central ideas and details
13	A	Command of evidence: quantitative
14	C	Command of evidence: quantitative
15	D	Command of evidence: textual
16	B	Command of evidence: textual
17	A	Command of evidence: textual
18	C	Inferences
19	B	Inferences
20	D	Inferences
21	B	Form, structure, and sense
22	C	Boundaries
23	A	Form, structure, and sense
24	D	Boundaries
25	B	Boundaries
26	D	Form, structure, and sense
27	C	Form, structure, and sense
28	A	Transitions
29	A	Transitions
30	C	Transitions
31	D	Rhetorical synthesis
32	B	Rhetorical synthesis
33	A	Rhetorical synthesis

Answer key

SAT Practice Test 2, Math

Module 1

NO.	ANSWER	SKILL
1	**B**	Percentages
2	**D**	Data analysis
3	**A**	Linear equations
4	**C**	Systems of equations
5	**C**	Functions
6	**A**	Nonlinear expressions
7	**D**	Ratios and rates
8	**B**	Triangles
9	**D**	Circles
10	**A**	Quadratics
11	**C**	Probability
12	**B**	Statistics
13	**C**	Scatterplots
14	**B**	Inequalities
15	**D**	Functions
16	**A**	Exponential functions
17	**C**	Linear functions
18	**B**	Percent change
19	**A**	Volume
20	**D**	Right triangles
21	**16**	Systems of equations
22	**4**	Quadratics
23	**15**	Percent change
24	**11**	Linear equations
25	**9**	Functions
26	**8**	Right triangles
27	**56**	Area

Module 2

NO.	ANSWER	SKILL
1	**A**	Exponential functions
2	**C**	Quadratics
3	**D**	Percentages
4	**B**	Volume
5	**C**	Functions
6	**A**	Statistics
7	**D**	Probability
8	**B**	Percentages
9	**C**	Equivalent expressions
10	**A**	Percentages
11	**D**	Systems of equations
12	**B**	Surface area
13	**A**	Circles
14	**B**	Equivalent expressions
15	**D**	Trigonometry
16	**C**	Exponential equations
17	**A**	Exponential functions
18	**B**	Linear functions in context
19	**D**	Absolute value
20	**C**	Ratios and rates
21	**10**	Linear equations
22	**8**	Circles in the plane
23	**8**	Quadratics
24	**154**	Quadratics
25	**15**	Percentages
26	**14**	Quadratics
27	**-3**	Systems with nonlinear equations

Score yourself. Count the questions you got right in each module.

Reading and Writing, Module 1: ___ of 33

Module 2: ___ of 33

Math, Module 1: ___ of 27

Module 2: ___ of 27

Answer explanations

SAT Practice Test 2, Reading and Writing, Module 1

Questions 1 to 17

1 **Choice C** Words in context

Restricting the movement of firewood is a way of keeping the beetle from spreading, so limit fits. Encourage and celebrate run against the officials' aim, and document does not describe a restriction.

2 **Choice A** Words in context

The colon explains that the menu has only five dishes, so limited is the logical word. Sprawling is the opposite, and the passage says nothing about indifference or age.

3 **Choice D** Words in context

She repeats herself to avoid disappointing buyers, which shows a reluctance to take risks that complacent captures. Curious would lead her to experiment, and nothing suggests generosity or impatience.

4 **Choice B** Words in context

Dense shade that blocks seedlings suggests very large, dominant trees, and imposing conveys that. Delicate and unremarkable would not cast such shade.

5 **Choice A** Words in context

Rather than signals a contrast with keeping the walls and beams, so the developers chose not to demolish the building. The other words do not contrast with conversion.

6 **Choice B** Words in context

The speech had no specific proposals and left listeners unsure of her intentions, so vague is the logical word. Precise is the opposite, and the speech was long, not brief.

7 **Choice C** Text structure and purpose

The underlined sentence says what the angle and duration of the dance mean, which explains how the dance carries information. It does not question bee communication or compare other insects.

8 **Choice D** Text structure and purpose

Lucía sets everything back where it was and cannot turn the calendar page, which shows her reluctance to disturb her aunt's life. She is careful, not careless, and the text does not explain the tidiness or suggest haste.

9 **Choice B** Text structure and purpose

The first stanza describes a river unaware of human things, and the second turns to people hoping that time will slow. No history, remedy or comparison of rivers appears.

10 **Choice C** Central ideas and details

The text says the harvests are modest and that the real yield is social. It denies that the gardens could feed a neighbourhood and says nothing about difficulty or about most residents.

11 **Choice D** Central ideas and details

The text says the viaduct's failure is what she is remembered for, but that a contractor swapped her steel for a cheaper alloy. Nothing is said about destroyed notebooks, dismissing vibration, or being first to use steel.

12 **Choice A** Command of evidence: quantitative

The claim compares the share preferring loose fruit in the older and younger groups, which the first choice does. The next uses the pre-packed share, and the last mixes the two measures, so neither compares the same preference.

13 **Choice A** Command of evidence: quantitative

A recovery after closure means citing the low in 2020 and the later rise, and the first choice does this with figures. The others mix up the years or leave out the low point.

14 **Choice D** Command of evidence: textual

The sparseness of the later music is shown by the work asking the orchestra to play almost nothing. The first quotation describes the early dense style, and the others are either not about sparseness or describe its effect.

15 **Choice C** Command of evidence: textual

Pages folded and stitched around the cover show the fragment was used to bind the ledger. The language, the contents of the ledger and other holdings do not address how the fragment was used.

16 **Choice B** Command of evidence: textual

Proponents say tides can be predicted far in advance, making the power easy to plan around. Cost and wildlife concerns are raised by critics, and the text does not compare the strength of tides and winds.

17 **Choice A** Inferences

Seeds that germinate in response to smoke are adapted to take advantage of conditions after fires. The text does not say they cannot grow elsewhere, and it contradicts the other choices.

Answer explanations

SAT Practice Test 2, Reading and Writing, Module 1

Questions 18 to 33

18 Choice B Inferences

The researcher notes the cause might run the other way, so the survey alone cannot show that reading builds vocabulary. It does not show harm, claim that weak readers never read, or restrict the findings to one university.

19 Choice D Inferences

Rueda calls the year of study without performance his most formative, which suggests he values study over performance. He does not say that young people should not perform, nor criticise travel or scores.

20 Choice C Form, structure, and sense

The adverbial phrase next week requires the future, and the plural subject students takes will present. The other forms are singular or past.

21 Choice C Boundaries

The three items form a parallel list of plural nouns, so textiles is correct. The other choices break the parallel structure.

22 Choice A Form, structure, and sense

The opening phrase must modify the person who did the studying, so Dr. Kim must be the subject that follows the comma. The other choices attach the phrase to findings, the meeting or a pronoun, creating a dangling modifier.

23 Choice B Boundaries

The relative clause which took nearly four years to build is nonessential and is closed by a comma before the main verb. A semicolon, colon or full stop would leave the main clause without a subject.

24 Choice D Form, structure, and sense

The subject each is singular, so the verb is receives. The other choices are plural or ungrammatical.

25 Choice D Boundaries

The semicolon joins two independent clauses, and the second is a result of the first, so as a result is correct.

26 Choice B Form, structure, and sense

The second clause gives the reason the discovery was important, so because is the logical conjunction.

27 Choice C Boundaries

In this inverted sentence the subject, mask and cloak, comes after the verb and is plural, so the verb must be were.

28 Choice A Transitions

The botanical classification contrasts with the culinary one, so however is the right transition.

29 Choice A Transitions

The fall in commuting times confirms what was expected, so Indeed is the logical transition.

30 Choice B Transitions

The sentence corrects the earlier belief with a fact, so In fact is the best transition. Likewise suggests similarity, and the others do not fit.

31 Choice D Rhetorical synthesis

To explain what the building is for, the choice must state its function, and only the first mentions tracking variable stars. The others give its history, visiting hours or an installation date.

32 Choice C Rhetorical synthesis

A comparison needs details about both rivers on the same points, which the first choice gives. The others describe one river or the shared sea.

33 Choice A Rhetorical synthesis

Age is conveyed by the date of around 1190, which only the first choice gives. The others describe the codex's contents, material or restoration.

Answer explanations

SAT Practice Test 2, Reading and Writing, Module 2

Questions 1 to 17

1 **Choice A** **Words in context**

She said enough to be friendly but nothing binding, so her remarks were carefully measured. Calibrated fits. Impulsive and defiant contradict the care described, and garbled would mean confused.

2 **Choice D** **Words in context**

The sentence describes a disease once confined to the tropics, so scourge, meaning a source of affliction, is the fitting noun. Haven and remedy suggest benefit, and relic implies something from the past.

3 **Choice B** **Words in context**

Wording that lets both sides claim a win must be capable of several readings, which elastic suggests. Rigid and emphatic would leave little room for dispute.

4 **Choice C** **Words in context**

Far from signals that she was the opposite of resistant, and she actively sought criticism. Impervious means unable to be affected, which fits the contrast. Vulnerable and sensitive would not contrast with seeking criticism.

5 **Choice B** **Words in context**

The colleagues preferred established procedures, so the methods must have been unconventional to them. Unorthodox fits. Conventional is the opposite, and the methods were later adopted, so they were not negligent.

6 **Choice A** **Words in context**

Although signals a contrast with the survey's finding that his descriptions were accurate, so the journals must have been dismissed as exaggerated. Verified and celebrated would not contrast with the survey, and transcribed does not fit with as exaggerated.

7 **Choice C** **Text structure and purpose**

The underlined sentence describes the slow accumulation of discrepancies, which shows that the revolution was gradual, contrary to the popular image of one decisive moment. It does not describe a single experiment, say the old model had no defenders, or introduce a theory to be evaluated.

8 **Choice D** **Text structure and purpose**

The sentence lists real hazards the speeches ignored, which supports Corliss's impression that the speakers lack knowledge of the sea. It does not mention a speech by him, claim the vessel is more dangerous, or say the harbour is now safe.

9 **Choice C** **Text structure and purpose**

The first sentence reports what the speaker was told, and the rest describes a house of language that has been filled with outside words. No house is praised, advice followed or languages ranked.

10 **Choice D** **Cross-text connections**

Text 2 notes the new styles began before photography spread, so the historian would say Text 1 mistakes cause for coincidence or acceleration. The historian says the camera made visible an existing interest, so does not deny all influence.

11 **Choice B** **Central ideas and details**

The text reports membraneless droplets that act as compartments, which means cells need less physical structure than thought. It says the picture is more crowded, not less, and oil is only an analogy.

12 **Choice A** **Central ideas and details**

The text argues that GDP counts all spending, including repair of damage, so it should not be read as welfare. It does not say GDP falls with repairs, or that economists have abandoned it.

13 **Choice A** **Command of evidence: quantitative**

At week 12 the graph shows 92 cm for the higher amount and 77 cm for the lower, a difference of 15 cm. The other choices change the size of the gap, swap the groups, or move the data to the wrong week.

14 **Choice C** **Command of evidence: quantitative**

Reliability concerns how little the time varies, so the correct choice compares the differences between rush hour and other times. One choice reports only rush hour times, one swaps the figures for the bus and car, and one reports the shortest time rather than the variation.

15 **Choice D** **Command of evidence: textual**

The claim is that a mistaken theory could still lead to effective remedies, and only the quotation saying the measures worked but not for the believed reason states this directly. The others describe the theory, the measures or one mechanism without making the point.

Answer explanations

SAT Practice Test 2, Reading and Writing, Module 2

Questions 18 to 33

18 Choice C Inferences

Narrow, winding streets inside walls contrasted with wider ones built once the threat lessened, which suggests the earlier layout reflected defensive needs. Speed and shared architects are not suggested, and the walls are connected to the layout.

19 Choice B Inferences

Dense cordgrass raised the surface in step with sea level while thin cover let the marsh drown, so restoring grass should help marshes survive. The text gives no support for sinking or for calm seas making grass unnecessary.

20 Choice D Inferences

Identical copies with the same page numbers let scholars point readers to the same words, so they could discuss and check claims against a shared text. The text does not say scholars avoided earlier work or relied on handwriting.

21 Choice B Form, structure, and sense

The relative pronoun is the subject of had spent and refers to people, so who is correct. Whom is the wrong case, and which and that they are not suitable.

22 Choice C Boundaries

The subject is the singular number, not the plural species, so has agrees. A number of would take a plural verb, but the number of takes a singular one.

23 Choice A Form, structure, and sense

The opening phrase compares Pryce with her contemporaries, so the subject that follows must be Pryce herself. The other choices make the countryside or her writing the thing being compared with people.

24 Choice D Boundaries

The items in this list already contain commas, so semicolons are used to separate them. Only the first choice separates the second and third items with a semicolon and the conjunction and.

25 Choice B Boundaries

The subject is the singular fraction, so the verb is is. The other choices do not agree or are not finite verbs.

26 Choice D Form, structure, and sense

After the negative adverb rarely, the auxiliary comes before the subject, so does an observer encounter is correct. The other choices fail to invert or fail to agree.

27 Choice C Form, structure, and sense

The streets belong to the city, which requires the singular possessive city's. Citys is not a word, and the plural forms do not fit one city.

28 Choice A Transitions

The sentence introduces newer findings that qualify the long-standing recommendation, so More recently, is the correct transition.

29 Choice A Transitions

The poets' embrace of railways contrasts with the general suspicion, so Nevertheless is the logical transition.

30 Choice C Transitions

The short lifespan is a limit that contrasts with the animal's intelligence, so Yet is the correct transition.

31 Choice D Rhetorical synthesis

The goal is to show how a discovery changed what is known, so the choice must contrast the earlier count with the newer one, which the first does. The others give dates, a detail of the new figures, or a method without the change.

32 Choice B Rhetorical synthesis

The audience wants the key result and its limit, and only the first choice gives both the success rate and the false alarms. The others give the method, a call for trials, or the success rate alone.

33 Choice A Rhetorical synthesis

A contrast needs both approaches with their features, which the first choice supplies. The others name the methods without features, describe only one method, or give a single reason.

Answer explanations

SAT Practice Test 2, Math, Module 1

Questions 1 to 14

1 **Choice B** **Percentages**

20% of 500 is 0.2 times 500, which is 100.

2 **Choice D** **Data analysis**

Team 5 has 25 and Team 1 has 15, and 25 minus 15 is 10.

3 **Choice A** **Linear equations**

Subtract 2x from both sides: 7x + 2 = 72. Then 7x = 70, so x = 10.

4 **Choice C** **Systems of equations**

Adding the equations gives 2x = 28, so x = 14.

5 **Choice C** **Functions**

Each step of 1 in x adds 6 to f(x), so the slope is 6. Then f(1) = 14 gives 6 + 8, so the intercept is 8.

6 **Choice A** **Nonlinear expressions**

Multiply the coefficients, 5 times 5 is 25, and add the exponents, 5 plus 6 is 11.

7 **Choice D** **Ratios and rates**

6 cups of sugar is 3 times 2 cups, so the flour is 3 times 7 cups, which is 21.

8 **Choice B** **Triangles**

The angles of a triangle add to 180°, so x + 2x + 6x = 9x = 180 and x = 20.

9 **Choice D** **Circles**

The circumference $2\pi r = 22\pi$ gives r = 11. The area is $\pi r^2 = 121\pi$.

10 **Choice A** **Quadratics**

The equation factors as (x − 8)(x + 4) = 0, so x = 8 or x = −4.

11 **Choice C** **Probability**

45 students travel that way and 18 of them are in Grade 10, so the probability is 18/45, which simplifies to 2/5. The fraction with 138 on the bottom uses every student.

12 **Choice B** **Statistics**

The first 5 scores total 345, and adding 81 gives 426. Divided by 6, the mean is 71.

13 **Choice C** **Scatterplots**

Substitute x = 6: 6(6) + 44 = 36 + 44 = 80.

14 **Choice B** **Inequalities**

The total is the 32 already joined plus 10 each week, and it must be at least 150, so 32 + 10w ≥ 150.

Answer explanations

SAT Practice Test 2, Math, Module 1

Questions 15 to 27

15 **Choice D** Functions

f(4) = 4(16) − 12 + 6 = 64 − 12 + 6 = 58.

16 **Choice A** Exponential functions

Tripling every 6 hours means the number of triplings is t/6, so the population is 800 times 3 to the power t/6.

17 **Choice C** Linear functions

The slope is (28 − 13)/(6 − 3) = 5. Using (3, 13), 13 = 5(3) + b gives b = −2.

18 **Choice B** Percent change

The increase is 1,500, and dividing by the original 6,000 gives 0.25, which is 25%. Dividing by the new value would give a smaller percent.

19 **Choice A** Volume

The volume is $\pi r^2 h = \pi(36)(8) = 288\pi$.

20 **Choice D** Right triangles

$5^2 + 12^2 = 169$, so the hypotenuse is $\sqrt{169} = 13$.

21 **16** Systems of equations

Adding x + y = 22 and x − y = 10 gives 2x = 32, so the larger number is 16.

22 **4** Quadratics

The equation factors as (x − 4)(x + 3) = 0, so the solutions are 4 and −3. The positive one is 4.

23 **15** Percent change

The increase is 3 dollars, and 3 divided by the original 20 is 0.15, which is 15 percent.

24 **11** Linear equations

Expanding gives 4x − 8 = 8x − 52. Collecting terms gives −4x = −44, so x = 11.

25 **9** Functions

8a − 6 = 66 gives 8a = 72, so a = 9.

26 **8** Right triangles

By the Pythagorean theorem, the other leg is $\sqrt{(100 - 36)} = \sqrt{64} = 8$.

27 **56** Area

The area of a triangle is half the base times the height: (1/2)(16)(7) = 56.

Answer explanations

SAT Practice Test 2, Math, Module 2

Questions 1 to 14

1 **Choice A** Exponential functions

Tripling every 2 hours means the number of triplings is t/2, so the population is 500 times 3 to the power t/2.

2 **Choice C** Quadratics

The equation factors as $(x - 8)(x + 1) = 0$, so $x = 8$ or $x = -1$.

3 **Choice D** Percentages

80% of 300 is 0.8 times 300, which is 240.

4 **Choice B** Volume

The volume is $\pi r^2 h = \pi(9)(7) = 63\pi$.

5 **Choice C** Functions

$f(4) = 3(16) - 24 + 5 = 48 - 24 + 5 = 29$.

6 **Choice A** Statistics

The first 6 scores total 480, and adding 94 gives 574. Divided by 7, the mean is 82.

7 **Choice D** Probability

37 students travel that way and 25 of them are in Grade 10, so the probability is 25/37. The fraction with 99 on the bottom uses every student.

8 **Choice B** Percentages

Start at 100. After the 25% rise the price is 125, and 40% off 125 leaves 75. That is 25% lower than the original.

9 **Choice C** Equivalent expressions

$(4x + 3)^2 = 16x^2 + 24x + 9$, and $(3x - 4)^2 = 9x^2 - 24x + 16$. Subtracting the second from the first gives $7x^2 + 48x - 7$.

10 **Choice A** Percentages

150 is 90 more than 60, and 90 / 60 = 1.5, so p = 150.

11 **Choice D** Systems of equations

A system has no solution when the lines are parallel but not identical. The second equation is 3 times the left side of the first with a different constant, so a must equal 15/3 = 5.

12 **Choice B** Surface area

Each cube has 6 faces, and gluing two faces together hides 2 of the 12, leaving 10 faces of area s^2. So $10s^2 = 640$, $s^2 = 64$, and $s = 8$.

13 **Choice A** Circles

Arc length is the radius times the central angle in radians: $9 \times \pi/6 = 9/6\pi$.

14 **Choice B** Equivalent expressions

The numerator factors as $(x - 7)(x - 5)$. Cancelling $x - 7$ leaves $x - 5$.

Answer explanations

SAT Practice Test 2, Math, Module 2

Questions 15 to 27

15 **Choice D** **Trigonometry**

A right triangle with opposite side 3 and hypotenuse 5 has adjacent side 4, so tan A = opposite/adjacent = 3/4.

16 **Choice C** **Exponential equations**

Write 4 as 2^2, so the right side is 2^(2x − 6). Equal bases give x + 4 = 2x − 6, so x = 10.

17 **Choice A** **Exponential functions**

A year is 12 months, so the value is multiplied by 0.9^(12/6) = 0.9^2 = 0.81 each year. That is a decrease of 1 − 0.81, or 19%.

18 **Choice B** **Linear functions in context**

The coefficient of x is the change in cost for each extra hour. The constant 45 is the fixed fee, and the 1 hour cost would be 48.5.

19 **Choice D** **Absolute value**

The inequality means x is within 3 of 6, so 3 ≤ x ≤ 9. That range has 7 integers, counting both ends.

20 **Choice C** **Ratios and rates**

The pumps fill 1/12 and 1/6 of the tank each hour, together 1/4 of it, so the time is 4 hours.

21 **10** **Linear equations**

Expanding gives 4x − 12 = 8x − 52. Collecting terms gives −4x = −40, so x = 10.

22 **8** **Circles in the plane**

Complete the square: $(x + 1)^2 + (y + 5)^2 = 38 + 1 + 25 = 64$. The radius is √64 = 8.

23 **8** **Quadratics**

For $ax^2 + bx + c = 0$ the solutions add to −b/a = −(−16)/2 = 8.

24 **154** **Quadratics**

The maximum is at t = −b/(2a) = 48/8 = 6. Then h(6) = −4(36) + 288 + 10 = 154.

25 **15** **Percentages**

Let L be the litres of the 20% solution. Then 0.2L + 0.7(10) = 0.4(L + 10). Solving gives L = 15.

26 **14** **Quadratics**

Exactly one real solution means the discriminant is zero: $b^2 − 4(49) = 0$, so $b^2 = 196$ and b = 14 (taking the positive value).

27 **-3** **Systems with nonlinear equations**

Setting the expressions equal gives $x^2 − 6x + (6 − k) = 0$. One solution means the discriminant is 0: 36 − 4(6 − k) = 0, so k = −3.